TUESDAY, OCTOBER 28, 2008

Hindustan Times

hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI • METRO

Price along with Hindustan Rs. 5.00 / Price along with Mint Rs. 4.75

Hindustan Times wishes its readers a very HAPPY DIWALI

Sprouting steel

DIJESHWAR SINGH/ HT

A worker installs sprouts at the AIIMS flyover in New Delhi on Monday.

Face-lift for flyover

- 'Sprouts' located at the AIIMS flyover has been designed as part of the ongoing pre-Commonwealth Games 2010 facelift in Delhi.
- There are a total of 480 sprouts made of rust-free, stainless steel
- It has two clusters of giant metallic sprouts — one has five with a 35 feet tall sprout, while the other cluster has over 400 smaller ones, 3 feet each.
- The globes of the sprout have been designed in such a way that the top half reflects the sky and lower half the green of the ground.
- Special LED lights have been used and various colours will also be used

Flyover makeover

AIIMS flyover will have Delhi's first site specific stainless steel sculpture 'sprouts'

Checking it out: Delhi CM Shiela Dikshit checks the model sculpture during a demonstration. (Left) The site at the AIIMS flyover

Damini Purkayastha

Have you wondered why the greens below the AIIMS flyover have been looking so unkempt these days? What are those squiggly bulb-like things sticking out of the ground?

HT City has good news for you. A few weeks on, the AIIMS flyover will house Delhi's first site specific, stainless steel contemporary sculpture, 'Sprouts', a project designed by Jindal Stainless Limited (JSL)as part of the ongoing pre-Commonwealth facelift in Delhi. "We were offered the AIIMS intersection for redevelopment and it was both a matter of great pride and challenge to give the city its most contemporary stainless spot... the display goes well with our emerging 'India Power' in the global league," says Ratan Jindal, VC & MD JSL.

Conceptualised in 2007 by sculptor Vibhor Sognai, Sprouts has two clusters of giant metallic sprouts-one has five, with the tallest one 35 feet tall, while the other cluster has over 400 smaller sprouts, 3 feet each. Made of rust-free, 304 and 316 grade stainless steel, the sculpture is organic to its location. "We decided we would do something unusual and global. It's been over 60 years since Independence and India is really beginning to Sprout, this is a celebration of that," explains the artist. The project cost around 3 crores, with over Rs 50 lakhs spent just on the lighting. The globes of the sprout have been designed in such a way that the top half reflects the sky and lower half the green of the ground. The ground itself has been re-landscaped by Ravi Punde and special lighting has been done by Caurtney Mark from UK.

"We are committed to making it the jewel of the city," explains NC Mathur, director, JSL."We plan to have the lights on till 2 am at night so that at night the view is spectacular. Maybe on national Days we could make them reflect our tricolour," he adds. However, going by the track record of how delhi treats its cultural heritage, he's concernd about the safety and upkeep of the art work. "This will be the pride of Delhi. We are really hoping that Delhiites will be proud of the project and not scratch or write on the Art work," he says.

damini.purkayastha@hindustantimes.com